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Top Skills

Consultative Selling
Solution Selling
SPIN Selling

Brad Friis

Senior Account Manager | SaaS Retention, Expansion & Enterprise Growth | 10 Years Growing PowerSchool's NZ & Australia Channel | 2,800 to 29,784 Users

Auckland, Auckland, New Zealand

Summary

I build long-term customer relationships into stronger commercial partnerships. For ten years, I managed and grew a PowerSchool reseller business across New Zealand and Australia. When I took responsibility for it in 2015, the business had 2,800 licensed users. By 2025, that had grown to 29,784. The role went well beyond traditional account management. I renegotiated the reseller agreement with the vendor, covering buy price, licensing terms and direct invoicing in local currency. I also developed new revenue streams, including implementation services, managed services, Ministry of Education-funded training and school-system integrations. Retention mattered just as much as growth. When a competitor targeted our largest customer, a five-campus education group in Queensland, I travelled there and spent a week working directly with stakeholders across the organisation. Rather than treating it as a renewal problem, I focused on understanding where they were getting value, where they weren't, and how we could improve their outcomes. We retained the account. Earlier in my career I ran my own web business for two years. It was an expensive but useful education in small-business buying behaviour, commercial strategy and the gap between what customers say they need and what they actually need. Roughly \$400,000 worth of education, as it turned out. Today I provide independent SaaS growth and retention consulting through Clarity Engine AI while looking for my next full-time account management opportunity in Auckland, New Zealand. I'm particularly interested in roles where account management means genuine commercial ownership: retaining strategic customers, understanding their businesses, identifying opportunities to create more value and growing accounts over time. If you have an enterprise customer portfolio that deserves that level of attention, I'd be interested in hearing about it.

Experience

PowerSchool Channel Partner NZ/AUST

New Zealand and Australian GM

August 2017 - September 2025 (8 years 2 months)

New Zealand

Grew the licensed user base from 2,800 to 29,784 across New Zealand and Australia over ten years, holding the vendor relationship and revenue model for the full decade.

Renegotiated the reseller agreement in full, replacing compulsory upfront licence purchasing with buy-as-needed pricing, then removed the vendor's 500-licence minimum, opening the book to a fifty-licence school.

Retained a multi-campus account that was actively evaluating a competitor, then expanded it into a paid consultancy engagement, an annual managed services agreement and paid training programmes.

Schoology Channel Partner - NZ/AUST

Sales and Marketing Manager (NZ/AUST)

November 2015 - August 2017 (1 year 10 months)

New Zealand and Australia

After continued success in the New Zealand market, we were awarded management of the Australian market.

Schoology Channel Partner NZ

National Sales & Marketing Manager (NZ)

September 2015 - November 2015 (3 months)

99 Corporation

National Sales & Marketing Manager

May 2013 - September 2015 (2 years 5 months)

Hastings, New Zealand

Grew the customer base by around 70% and income by around 120% at 99 Corporation, lifting profit per customer by around 30%, per the business owner.

Introduced a 50% upfront deposit, new to the business, credited by the owner with a substantial cashflow improvement, alongside new billed lines: set-up costs, higher hourly rates, volume-based pricing and script-writing fees.

Opened a new data-sales revenue line to direct marketing companies including Nielsen and Martins, while holding national accounts including Xero, LexisNexis and Promax with billing and contract negotiation ownership.

Xplore - your web agency

Business Development/Sales Manager

April 2009 - May 2013 (4 years 2 months)

Napier, Hawke's Bay

Sold a \$70,000 website to Rembrandt Fine Arts, the largest project the agency built, with full SKU control and accounting integration in scope.

Held the Hawke's Bay Chamber of Commerce account for four years, essentially the full tenure, while running a two-year resell cycle across redesigns, copy refreshes, SEO and monthly bolt-on modules.

Grew agency headcount from 5 to 12 (140%) over the tenure, supporting the company's expansion.

Mysimplesiteman

Founder/Director

August 2006 - February 2009 (2 years 7 months)

Napier

Founded and built a \$399-a-year CMS product for New Zealand SMBs over two years, investing close to \$400,000 before recognising the tooling couldn't support the larger-ticket sites the market actually needed, then walked away.

Canwest Media Ltd.

Account Manager

October 2003 - August 2006 (2 years 11 months)

Hawkes Bay

Held the Harvey Norman account for the full three years, the anchor account of the tenure.

Exceeded monthly and annual budget targets across the tenure, peaking at 178% of target.

Delivered a minimum 10% year-on-year increase against annual targets throughout the role.

Tracta - Agrimarketing agency

Business Development Manager

February 2001 - October 2003 (2 years 9 months)

Napier, Hawkes Bay

Grew total advertising revenue by 60% and advertiser volume by 40% over three years for Hawke's Bay Tourism's Visitor Guide and web portal, as the account holder connecting publisher, advertisers and tourism operators.

Onboarded traditional print operators into early digital packages, lifting average deal size by around 14%, alongside print renewals.

Increased advertisers from 42 to 86 for the Gold Pages/Gold Listings two-tier product

Education

Hastings Boys High School

· (1983 - 1988)